



Mali

Africa

Dogon dama

The Dogon people of Mali create elaborate masks and costumes for the dama dance ceremony, which is held to honor deceased village elders.

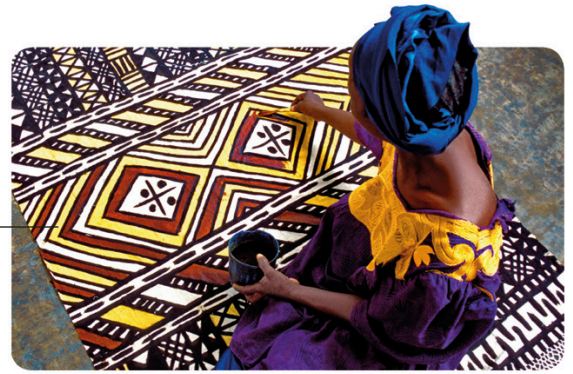
An ancient Arabic manuscript on astronomy from Timbuktu



Precious manuscripts

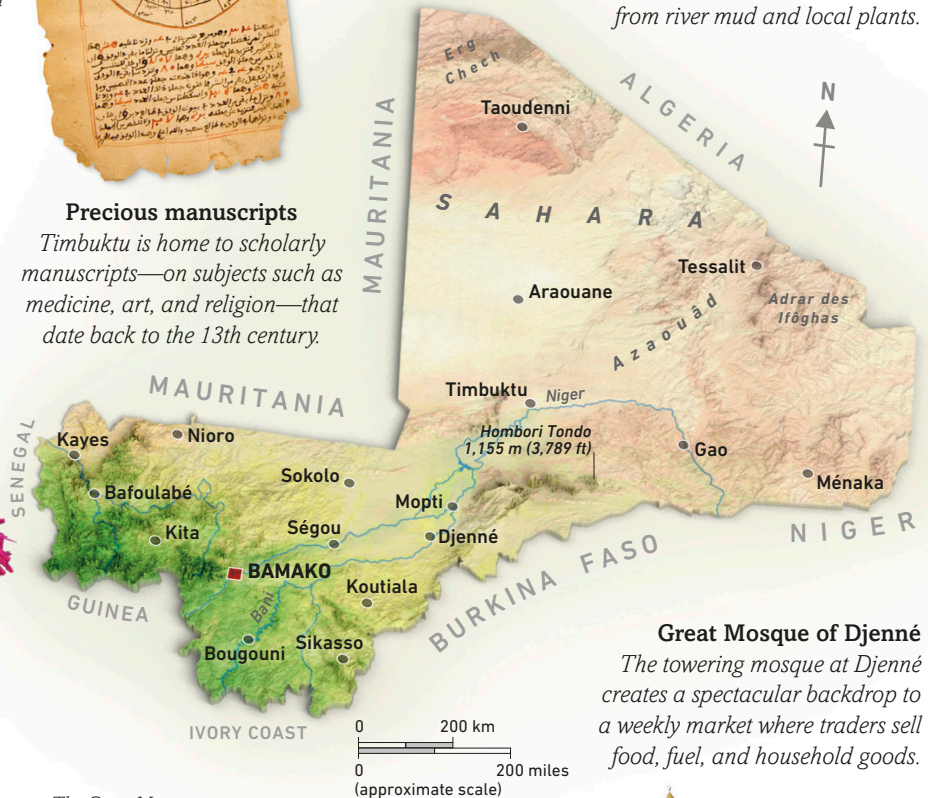
Timbuktu is home to scholarly manuscripts—on subjects such as medicine, art, and religion—that date back to the 13th century.

Striking, geometric designs often decorate bôgôlanfini.



Patterned textiles

Bôgôlanfini is a traditional Malian handwoven cotton fabric. Its bold, colored patterns are created with natural dyes made from river mud and local plants.



Great Mosque of Djenné

The towering mosque at Djenné creates a spectacular backdrop to a weekly market where traders sell food, fuel, and household goods.

The Great Mosque was constructed in 1907 using mud bricks.



- 478,841 sq miles (1,240,192 sq km)
- 19.6 million
- Bamako
- Bambara, Fulani, other languages (+3)

Between **dry desert** and **tropical savannah**, Mali is a large, **flat country**. The **Niger River**, which runs through it, is used for **fishing**, **transportation**, and **trade**. Mali's main exports are **gold** and **cotton**.